

Religion

The Divine Family Tree

The Old Gods - Born of the Great Song

Before the New Gods existed, four brothers emerged from the Great Song itself: Mikani, God of War and Order; Poaranji, God of Strength and Sailors; Renedin, God of Dreams and the Eternal Plane; and Haxenylian, God of Protection and Wisdom. These four were the original divine beings, and their brotherhood would shatter when Haxenylian broke divine law by loving a mortal woman.

The First Generation of New Gods - Children of Forbidden Love

When Haxenylian fell in love with the mortal Lady Gaialana, their union produced twins: Vapaz, God of the Sky, and Zopha, Goddess of the Sea. These siblings share the same divine father and mortal mother, making them full brother and sister. Their birth-impossible, unprecedented-triggered the War of Gods I, which killed their father and ended the reign of the Old Gods. Vapaz would rise from that war to become King of the Gods, while Zopha would carry the grief of their origins forever.

The Royal Line - Vapaz's Descendants

Vapaz married Nimlye, Goddess of Secrets and Fate, making her Queen of the Gods. Together they have one son: Razar, God of the Sun, who stands as crown prince of the divine hierarchy. However, Vapaz also fathered a daughter with Iswan, Goddess of Alchemy-this daughter is Allan, Goddess of Nature. Allan is therefore Razar's half-sister, sharing a father but not a mother. The relationship between Nimlye and Iswan, given this history, remains diplomatically tense.

Zopha's Line

Zopha was married to Loart, the minor Old God of Wealth who defected to help the New Gods during the war. Loart died in that conflict, leaving Zopha widowed

before she ever bore children. Her sons, Paxtino, God of Peace, Rebirth, and Redemption, and Ekhasostio, God of Vengeance, Desire, and Destruction, came later-born not from any union but from Zopha's tears. Myth holds that her grief was so profound it took physical form, splitting into two opposing forces: one embodying healing and hope, the other embodying rage and ruin. Because they emerged after Loart's death and not from any father, Paxtino and Ekhasostio have no paternal lineage. They are solely Zopha's children.

Iswan and Finore

Iswan, Goddess of Alchemy, is married to Finore, God of the Forge. Together they have a son: Sielaph, God of Lightning. This makes Sielaph and Allan half-siblings through their mother Iswan, though Allan's father is Vapaz while Sielaph's father is Finore. The Forge-Born line represents divine craftsmanship and transformation.

The Third Generation - Razar's Daughter

Razar, God of the Sun, and Paha, Goddess of Horses, are the parents of Nellebrie, Goddess of Disasters. Nellebrie is therefore Vapaz's granddaughter and the great-granddaughter of Haxenylian-the only known member of the divine third generation.

Birth of Vapaz and Zopha

Lady Gaialana's pregnancy was impossible. A mortal body cannot sustain divine life - the child burns from within. Haxenylian knew this, but loved her too desperately to let her go. So he made a bargain with his own essence: he would split his divine nature, giving half to the child growing inside her, so the pregnancy wouldn't kill her. But Gaialana was carrying twins.

The birth happened during a storm at sea. Haxenylian had taken her to a remote island to hide from his brothers. When her labor began, the sky opened. Vapaz was born first, during a lightning strike that split an ancient oak. The moment he drew breath, the storm intensified - winds howled, thunder shook the earth. He was born claiming the sky itself.

Zopha came hours later, as dawn broke and the storm calmed. She was born as the tide pulled back, and when she cried, the ocean answered - waves rose and

crashed in rhythm with her breathing. Sailors three hundred miles away reported strange tidal patterns that night.

Gaialana survived the birth. For two years, she raised them on that island while Haxenylian visited when he could slip away from his brothers' watch. The twins grew faster than mortal children speaking in sentences by six months, walking by eight. Their divine nature asserted itself early: Vapaz called birds from the sky to play with him; Zopha made tide pools appear in dry sand.

Then Renedin found them. He came disguised as a traveling merchant seeking shelter from a storm. Gaialana welcomed him. That night, while the twins slept, Renedin murdered her - not with violence, but by trapping her in an eternal dream where she forgot to wake. Her body simply stopped breathing.

When Haxenylian arrived the next morning and found her dead, his grief cracked the sky. The twins, now toddlers, watched their father weep over their mother's body. Vapaz remembers this - a core memory that shaped everything he became. Zopha claims she doesn't remember, but she dreams of it constantly.

War of Gods I - Battle Structure

The Old Gods' Forces: Mikani (War/Order) - led the offensive Poaranji (Strength/Sailors) controlled the seas during battle Renedin (Dreams) - assassinated Lady Gaialana, fought through nightmares and psychological warfare

The New Gods' Forces: Haxenylian (Protection/Wisdom) - died defending his children Loart (Wealth) - defected from old gods, died securing the new gods' victory Vapaz and Zopha - young, traumatized, but powerful

DIVINE BARRIER SECTION (Create as new header section):

- The barrier prevents gods from existing physically in the mortal realm, not from acting upon it
- Functions like a window-gods can reach through for blessings, curses, punishments, but cannot walk permanently in true forms
- Established after War of Gods I under Vapaz's rule
- Allows: projection of will (blessings, curses), communication through dreams/visions/oracles, temporary manifestation to saints, influence through followers and institutions

- Prevents: permanent physical presence, direct divine warfare on mortal soil, demons crossing in massive amounts
- World doors on Mystic Isles are weak points where the barrier thins
- Breaking it would reset cosmos to primordial chaos, merging mental and physical realms

WORSHIP AND DIVINE POWER SECTION:

- Worship affects divine power, but new gods insulated themselves via Circle of Eternal Light
- Old gods were directly fueled by worship (more belief = more power, vulnerable to faith shifts)
- New gods collectivized faith—as long as religion exists across three sub-denominations, gods sustained collectively
- Individual gods still feel intensity fluctuations (Razar stronger in summer, Zopha during monsoons, Nellebrie paradoxically gains power during disasters)
- Order of the Pure Ones threatens gods long-term—if it grew significantly, gods would weaken measurably

AFTERLIFE KNOWLEDGE SECTION:

- Mortal knowledge comes from revealed knowledge, not speculation
- Sources: Saints' visions (especially Saint Duri who lived 77 years), religious texts (Zyrazithia, Tome of Renedin, Book of Purity)
- Accepted as religious truth rather than empirically verified fact

RENEDIN

Title: God of Dreams and the Eternal Plane

Domains: Dreams, nightmares, madness, manipulation, the subconscious, lies that feel true, the space between realities

Colors: Shifting grey (nothing solid), pale sickly yellow (jaundice, corruption), black that's almost purple (bruise-colored)

Symbols: Closed eye, Mask, Door (slightly open — threshold between states), Moth (drawn to false light), Empty mirror (reflection that lies)

Personality: Renedin is the most dangerous of the Old Gods because he believes his own narrative. Every manipulation, every whisper, every act of cruelty - he's convinced himself it was necessary. When his brothers felt secure, Renedin reminded them of threats. When they felt paranoid, Renedin confirmed their fears. He needed them unstable because unstable gods needed him - the one who understood the dream realm, the one who could see what was coming.

He murdered Lady Gaialana. Not in passion, not in battle - deliberately, to provoke a war he wanted. He knew Haxenylian's love for her would fracture the peace between old and new gods. He manufactured the tragedy that killed his own family.

His "Love" for Iswan: Renedin is capable of something that looks like love - obsessive focus, genuine interest, even tenderness. But it's always transactional beneath the surface. He loved that Iswan was powerful enough to be useful. He loved that she believed in him. When she betrayed him, he didn't feel heartbreak - he felt cheated. She was supposed to be his.

In the Garden: He's partially awake, and he's been waiting. Not grieving his brothers - planning. The "lonely survivor seeking justice" act is exactly that: an act. He wants to merge the mortal and eternal planes because in dreams, he is god. Waking reality has rules he can't control. Dreams are his domain entirely.

Why He's Unsympathetic: He's a manipulator who plays victim. He destroyed his own family and blames everyone else. He's incapable of genuine accountability.

The Danger: He's patient. He's been waiting thousands of years in the Garden. And he's had nothing to do but think and plan and whisper to anyone who'll listen.

Worship Note: The Brotherhood of Westwinds believes Renedin was wrongfully imprisoned for trying to "preserve the old ways." Their sacred text, the Tome of Renedin, is likely influenced by dreams he's sent from the Garden - he's been recruiting from his prison.

POARANJI

Title: God of Strength and Sailors

Domains: Physical might, the sea (as dangerous force), storms, endurance, brotherhood among men, laborers

Colors: Dark navy (deep sea), rust orange (weathered metal/rope), salt white

Symbols: Anchor, Rope (knotted), Trident, Clenched fist raised, Breaking wave

Personality: Poaranji was brute strength personified — not stupid, but uncomplicated. He valued loyalty, physical prowess, and directness. He didn't scheme; he didn't manipulate. When Mikani said the new gods were a threat, Poaranji believed him. When Renedin whispered that war was coming regardless, Poaranji prepared for it. He was a follower, not a leader, and he followed the wrong voices.

His Death: Zopha drowned him. A god of sailors and the sea, drowned by a goddess who became the sea through grief. He couldn't swim against a current made of divine sorrow. He was strong, but strength means nothing against an ocean.

Why He's Partially Sympathetic: He wasn't cruel - he was used. He trusted his brothers and they led him to destruction.

The Tragedy: Poaranji probably would have accepted the new gods if anyone had bothered to talk to him directly. He just wanted to belong to something, and his brothers gave him that belonging.

Worship Note: The Brotherhood venerates him as the patron of working men - sailors, laborers, soldiers. "Strength in brotherhood" is their reading of him, ignoring how that brotherhood led him astray.

MIKANI

Enhanced Domains: Battle, military discipline, hierarchy, conquest, law through force, glory

Colors: Iron black, blood red, steel grey

Symbols: Sword (pointed downward — stabbed into ground, claiming territory), Fist, Helm, Banner/standard, Chain of rank

Personality: Mikani believed in order - but his order. He was the eldest of the Old Gods, and he saw the birth of Vapaz and Zopha (new gods, a new kind of god) as a threat to everything he'd built. He wasn't entirely wrong - they did overthrow him. But Mikani's response was disproportionate. He didn't try to integrate the new

gods; he tried to destroy them before they could grow. He was rigid where flexibility might have saved him. Proud where humility might have earned allies.

Why He's Unsympathetic: He chose war over adaptation. He saw children as threats to be eliminated rather than family to be welcomed.

The Complexity: Mikani wasn't evil — he was afraid. He'd fought to establish order in a chaotic cosmos, and these new beings threatened to undo everything. His fear made him cruel. Renedin saw this fear and fed it.

Worship Note: The Brotherhood venerates him as "true order" - strength that doesn't compromise. They see Vapaz's rule as weakness pretending to be civilization.

LOART

Title: Minor God of Wealth

Domains: Prosperity, ambition, trade, treasure, generosity, social climbing, devotion

Colors: Rich copper (not gold - that's Razar's), deep green (money/envy), black (ambition's shadow)

Symbols: Scales (trade/balance), Key (unlocking wealth/status), Overflowing cup, Climbing vine, Coin with a hole (wealth that passes through)

Personality: Loart was born a minor god - barely more than a spirit of commerce. He wanted more. When he saw Zopha, daughter of Haxenylian, he didn't just see beauty - he saw elevation. But here's the complexity: somewhere in his climb, he actually fell in love. His ambition brought him to Zopha; genuine devotion made him stay. He became generous where he'd been grasping. He died throwing himself between danger and the twins - children that weren't even his. A social climber doesn't do that.

Why He's Sympathetic: His ambition was human and relatable. He grew beyond it. His final act was pure selflessness.

The Tragedy: Zopha will never know if he loved her first or loved her status first. She chooses to believe the former, but the doubt is part of her endless grief. And Loart can never reassure her - he's gone.

Worship Note: The Brotherhood of Westwinds venerates him as a god of "earned wealth" and "rising above your station" - they've stripped away the love story and

kept only the ambition.

Role in War of Gods I: Defected from the old gods because he believed new belief = new wealth. He died protecting Vapaz and Zopha during the final assault, taking a blow meant for them.

Victory: Saved the Zopha and Vapaz Failure: Died doing it

HAXENYLIAN

Title: God of Protection

Domains: Fatherhood, women, children, guardianship, the home, song/voice, sanctuary

Colors: Warm bronze (protective but warm), deep brown (earth/stability), cream (gentleness)

Symbols: Shield, Open doorway, Cupped hands (sheltering), Songbird (for Gaialana), Hearth

Personality: Haxenylian was the god you prayed to when you were afraid. Not a warrior god - a protector god. The difference matters. He didn't seek battle; he stood between danger and those who couldn't defend themselves. He was patient with his children, present in ways other gods weren't. His love for Lady Gaialana was genuine and gentle - he didn't desire her beauty or power, he simply loved how she sang. That a god of protection couldn't protect the woman he loved is the cruelest irony. His death holding the line for Vapaz and Zopha was completely in character - he died as he lived.

Why He's Sympathetic: He was a good father. He loved softly. He died for his children without hesitation.

The Tragedy: His son Vapaz became a distant, politically calculating king.

Everything Haxenylian stood for - warmth, presence, protection of the vulnerable - faded from divine culture after his death.

Role in War of Gods I: Died holding the line so his children could reach safety. His last act was pushing Vapaz and Zopha through a barrier he couldn't follow through. He faced Mikani knowing he would lose, buying time.

Victory: Bought time for victory Failure: Died without seeing it

Quick Reference Table — Old Gods

God | Primary Color | Secondary | Key Symbol | Sympathetic? Haxenylian | Warm bronze | Brown, cream | Shield / Doorway | Yes Loart | Rich copper | Green, black | Scales / Key | Yes (complex) Mikani | Iron black | Red, grey | Sword / Helm | No (but understandable) Poaranji | Dark navy | Rust, white | Anchor / Rope | Partially (tragic pawn) Renedin | Shifting grey | Sickly yellow, bruise-purple | Closed eye / Mask | No (villain)

Domains Distribution

Domain | Old God | New God | Tension Protection | Haxenylian | - | No one replaced him; Vapaz rules but doesn't protect Wealth | Loart | - (Razar has prosperity) | Razar's is "earned through divine favor"; Loart's was "seized through ambition" War | Mikani | - | Vapaz uses Sielaph for punishment, but no war god exists now Strength/Sea | Poaranji | Zopha | She took his domain and transformed it through grief Dreams | Renedin | Nimlye (secrets/fate) | She guards his prison; they share liminal space

RAZAR

[GOD OF THE SUN]

RAZAR

Title: God of the Sun

Domain: Light, warmth, wrath, prosperity, judgment, timekeeping (the day)

Colors: Gold (primary), burnt orange, bright yellow

Symbol: Sun disk, gold coins

Sacred Animal: Songbirds, Lions

Major Myths (King Taveth the Vain): King Taveth built a palace with windows facing east so he could watch the sunrise every morning. He declared himself "Razar's Chosen" and demanded his subjects bow to him at dawn as they would bow to the sun. Razar did not appreciate this. One morning, the sun rose everywhere except over Taveth's palace. His kingdom had daylight; his throne room stayed dark. For seven days, shadows clung to Taveth while his subjects walked in light. Taveth went mad trying to find the sun. He died still searching.

DIVINE CLASSIFICATION

Category: New God

Domain: Sun, Light

Symbol:

Sacred Animal:

Sacred Color:

ORIGIN & NATURE

Creation/Birth:

Relationship to Other Gods:

True Nature/Form:

How They Manifest to Mortals (Their Appearance):

DIVINE FAMILY

Parents:

Siblings:

Children (Divine):

Mortal Descendants:

PERSONALITY & TEMPERAMENT

Core Traits:

Relationship with Humanity:

What Pleases Them:

What Angers Them:

WORSHIP

Primary Worshippers: All Aicruaeans (state religion centers on Razar)

Temple Style: Major shrine in Lajazer overseen by royal-appointed chief priests.

Clergy:

Major Festivals: Sun Solstice (mid-summer) — Aicruae's grandest holiday;

Offerings:

Prayers:

DIVINE POWERS

Abilities:

Limitations:

How They Grant Power to Mortals:

Known Interventions in History:

MYTHOLOGY

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Major Myths: The Wrath of Fire: During the time of sin, a group of women stole an offering from Razar's temple-a tiny sun-shaped jewel-and cast it into a lake as an offering to Zopha, whom they deemed more worthy of worship. Razar, already harboring a strained relationship with his aunt Zopha, did not take kindly to this transgression. To punish them, he covered the earth in eternal sunlight for seventy days. Crops and lakes dried up; many of Zopha's followers perished.

When the women came pleading, he said only: "Ask your mighty goddess to save you." They prayed ceaselessly, but Zopha-still grieving Loart and believing the punishment fit their crime-did not intervene. Only after the women died did Zopha urge her brother Vapaz to stop Razar. Why the Songbird Sings at

Dawn: Before Razar claimed the sun, mornings were silent and dark. A mortal king, seeking to comfort mortals afraid of the night, worked with the first songbird to create a song taught to sing just before dawn. The song was a promise: "Light returns. Always, light returns." When Razar heard the songbird, he was moved by its faith and decreed that from that moment, his sun would rise without fail each day, so the songbird's promise would never be broken.

Role in War of Gods:

Relationship with Saints:

CURRENT STATUS (By Era)

During Solis's Era:

During Crandona's Era:

By Minara's Era:

ROLE IN NARRATIVE

Direct Appearances:

Indirect Influence:

Characters Tied to Them:

NOTES

Aicruae's preeminent deity. The kingdom's flag and rituals especially honor Razar, reflecting the importance of sunlight to Aicruan agriculture and rulership.

[VAPAZ]

[GOD OF THE SKY, KING OF THE NEW GODS]

Title: God of the Sky, Weather, and Kingship

Domain: Authority, oaths, justice, the heavens, weather

Colors: Royal blue (the sky), white (clouds), silver (stars/moonlight)

Symbol: Crown, eye

Sacred Animal: Hawks, Eagles

Role in War of Gods I: Fought Mikani directly. Young, grief-fueled, reckless. He won not through skill but through refusing to stop. Mikani was a god of order; Vapaz was pure chaos born of grief. The sky itself cracked during their fight. His victory was ugly — he didn't defeat Mikani so much as outlast him through sheer unwillingness to die.

Victory: Defeated Mikani Failure: Couldn't save his father; watched him die

DIVINE CLASSIFICATION

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Category: Old God / New God

Domain:

Symbol:

Sacred Animal:

Sacred Color:

ORIGIN & NATURE

Creation/Birth:

Relationship to Other Gods:

True Nature/Form:

How They Manifest to Mortals(Their Appearance):

DIVINE FAMILY

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Parents:

Siblings:

Children (Divine):

Mortal Descendants:

PERSONALITY & TEMPERAMENT

Core Traits:

Relationship with Humanity:

What Pleases Them:

What Angers Them:

WORSHIP

Primary Worshippers:

Temple Style:

Clergy:

Major Festivals:

Offerings:

Prayers:

DIVINE POWERS

Abilities:

Limitations:

How They Grant Power to Mortals:

Known Interventions in History:

MYTHOLOGY

Major Myths: The Lovers of Sky and Sea: A forbidden love between Vapaz, god of the sky, and his sister Zopha, goddess of the sea, created violent storms across the world. To conceal their affair, they generated the seasons-calm summers when they could meet, and stormy winters when they must part. People of the Sky: (Cross-reference: See Iswan for full "People of the Sky vs People of the Mountain" myth) After the War of Gods I, not all minor gods sided with the gods of new.

When the old gods lost, Vapaz-with help from the other new gods-stripped the rebellious minor gods of their divinity and cast them down to live among mortals. Some accepted this punishment with grace, valuing that Vapaz spared their lives. They populated with humans and became known as the People of the Sky.

Role in War of Gods:

Relationship with Saints:

CURRENT STATUS (By Era)

During Solis's Era:

During Crandona's Era:

By Minara's Era:

ROLE IN NARRATIVE

Direct Appearances:

Indirect Influence:

Characters Tied to Them:

NOTES

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[ALLAN]

[GODDESS OF NATURE]

Title: Goddess of Nature

Domain: Growth, fertility, harvest, healing (herbal/natural), spring, hope, the wild

Colors: Forest green (primary), gold (sunlight through leaves), earthy brown

Symbol: Leaf, antler, flowers, trees

Sacred Animal: Deer, Wolves

DIVINE CLASSIFICATION

Category: Old God / New God

Domain:

Symbol:

Sacred Animal:

Sacred Color:

ORIGIN & NATURE

Creation/Birth:

Relationship to Other Gods:

True Nature/Form:

How They Manifest to Mortals(Their Apperance):

DIVINE FAMILY

Parents:

Siblings:

Children (Divine):

Mortal Descendants:

PERSONALITY & TEMPERAMENT

Core Traits:

Relationship with Humanity:

What Pleases Them:

What Angers Them:

WORSHIP

Primary Worshippers:

Temple Style:

Clergy:

Major Festivals:

Offerings:

Prayers:

DIVINE POWERS

Abilities:

Limitations:

How They Grant Power to Mortals:

Known Interventions in History:

MYTHOLOGY

Major Myths:Allan of the Earth: The goddess Allan is said to have been “born of humans’ love for the earth”-though in truth, she is the daughter of Vapaz and Iswan. (The mythic version conceals her true parentage for theological reasons.) Allan was born from flowers, trees, and grass-the embodiment of everything pure and right with the earth. For the longest time, she loved humans and nature equally. One day, Allan took the form of a deer and ventured into a human forest, making friends with animals and running through fields in bliss. When night fell, humans with pitchforks came searching for a wolf. They burned trees, killed animals, and polluted the air. Allan’s power weakened, but she still approached them to protect a small wolf pup they had caught. “I am the goddess Allan,” she told them—but they saw only a deer. “What you are doing is wrong,” she said, but they were hungry and disillusioned and ignored her. One man struck her stomach with his sword. She pleaded again, but they struck blow after blow. With each wound, the goddess lost more of herself. They left her bleeding to focus on the wolf pup, killing it before her, then abandoning the forest. That day, Allan lost her love for humanity. The hatred that now festered in her heart is said to have turned her once-blonde hair black.

Role in War of Gods:

Relationship with Saints:

CURRENT STATUS (By Era)

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During Solis’s Era:

During Crandona’s Era:

By Minara’s Era:

ROLE IN NARRATIVE

Direct Appearances:

Indirect Influence:

Characters Tied to Them:

NOTES

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[ZOPHA]

[GODDESS OF THE SEA/THE OCEAN]

Title: Goddess of the Sea and Grief

Domain: Love (especially lost love, longing, devotion), mourning, tides/change, music

Colors: Deep teal (ocean depths), seafoam green (vibrant sea), storm grey (grief), pearl white

Symbol: Harps, pearls, sea salt, sea rocks, shell, teardrop

Sacred Animal: Whales, Seabirds (Albatross)

Role in War of Gods I: Fought Poaranji for control of the seas. This should have been a slaughter (Poaranji was ancient, powerful). But Zopha had just watched her mother die. Her grief was so heavy it sank. She drowned Poaranji in her own sorrow — not through combat, but by making the seas too heavy for even a god of strength to swim. Poaranji's defeat was slow suffocation.

Victory: Drowned Poaranji Failure: Couldn't protect Loart; arrived too late

DIVINE CLASSIFICATION

Category: Old God / New God

Domain:

Symbol:

Sacred Animal:

Sacred Color:

ORIGIN & NATURE

Creation/Birth:

Relationship to Other Gods:

True Nature/Form:

How They Manifest to Mortals(Their Appearance):

DIVINE FAMILY

Parents:

Siblings:

Children (Divine):
Mortal Descendants:

PERSONALITY & TEMPERAMENT

Core Traits:
Relationship with Humanity:
What Pleases Them:
What Angers Them:

WORSHIP

Primary Worshippers:
Temple Style:
Clergy:
Major Festivals:
Offerings:
Prayers:

DIVINE POWERS

Abilities:
Limitations:
How They Grant Power to Mortals:
Known Interventions in History:

MYTHOLOGY

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Major Myths: Zopha's Tears and the Salt of the Sea: When her husband Loart died, Zopha wept for forty days and forty nights. Her tears fell into the ocean, and because divine sorrow is heavier than mortal grief, they sank to the ocean floor. But grief so profound could not simply disappear—it transformed. Zopha's tears became salt, saturating the ocean, ensuring that all who taste the sea taste divine sorrow. This is why sailors leave offerings to Zopha: to thank her for sharing her grief, making mortal sorrows seem smaller by comparison. The Myth of Ekhaostio and Paxtino: The twin gods Ekhaostio and Paxtino were born of Zopha's tears.

After the War of the Gods, Zopha was struck by fear, uncertainty, and incredible loneliness following Loart's death. One day as she wept, one of her tears split in two. These tears took shape to form Paxtino and Ekhaostio-two sons born without a father, knowing only a mother. Paxtino embodies peace, rebirth, and redemption; Ekhaostio embodies vengeance, desire, and destruction. They exist as opposing forces born from the same grief. The Lovers of Sky and Sea: (Cross-reference: See Vapaz) A forbidden love between Vapaz and his sister Zopha created violent storms. To conceal their affair, they generated seasons-calm summers to meet and stormy winters to part.

Role in War of Gods:

Relationship with Saints:

CURRENT STATUS (By Era)

During Solis's Era:

During Crandona's Era:

By Minara's Era:

ROLE IN NARRATIVE

Direct Appearances:

Indirect Influence:

Characters Tied to Them:

NOTES

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[PAHA]

[GODDESS OF HORSES]

Title: Goddess of Horses and Freedom

Domain: Travel, speed, wild joy, independence, the wind

Colors: White (wild horses), chestnut brown, sky blue (open freedom)

Symbol: [None listed in this batch beyond animals]

Sacred Animal: Divine Horses, Wild mustangs

DIVINE CLASSIFICATION

Category: Old God / New God

Domain:

Symbol:

Sacred Animal:

Sacred Color:

ORIGIN & NATURE

Creation/Birth: Came into existence when mortals domesticated horses but still feared them. Born from mortal awe and terror.

Relationship to Other Gods:

True Nature/Form:

How They Manifest to Mortals (Their Appearance):

DIVINE FAMILY

Parents:

Siblings:

Children (Divine):

Mortal Descendants:

PERSONALITY & TEMPERAMENT

Core Traits:

Relationship with Humanity:

What Pleases Them:

What Angers Them:

WORSHIP

Primary Worshippers:

Temple Style:

Clergy:

Major Festivals:

Offerings:

Prayers:

DIVINE POWERS

Abilities:

Limitations:

How They Grant Power to Mortals:

Known Interventions in History:

MYTHOLOGY

Major Myths: The Great Eclipse: During the Wrath of Fire, Paha's divine horses dragged the sun behind the highest mountain to hide it from Razar. The sudden darkness terrified mortals, who sang Noirta's cycle song until Razar relented. According to prophecy, one of Paha's horses will carry the last mortal soul to the Land of Great Sleep when the world ends.

Role in War of Gods:

Relationship with Saints:

CURRENT STATUS (By Era)

During Solis's Era:

During Crandona's Era:

By Minara's Era:

ROLE IN NARRATIVE

Direct Appearances:

Indirect Influence:

Characters Tied to Them:

NOTES

[NIMLYE]

[GODDESS OF SECRETS AND FATE]

Title: Goddess of Secrets and Fate

Domain: Knowledge, prophecy, memory, the moon, shadows, death (as fate's end)

Colors: Silver (moon), deep purple (mystery), black (hidden things)

Symbol: Mirror, Veil, Wen, Crescent moon

Sacred Animal: Moths, Spiders

Role in War of Gods I: Used Iswan's intelligence to create the Garden of Unspoken Names. She didn't fight directly; she built the prison that would hold the defeated

gods. Her role was strategic, not combative. She watched, waited, and prepared the cage.

Victory: Built the Garden Failure: Had to watch Renedin - whom she also loved - be imprisoned

DIVINE CLASSIFICATION

Category: Old God / New God

Domain:

Symbol:

Sacred Animal:

Sacred Color:

ORIGIN & NATURE

Creation/Birth:

Relationship to Other Gods:

True Nature/Form:

How They Manifest to Mortals(Their Apperance):

DIVINE FAMILY

Parents:

Siblings:

Children (Divine):

Mortal Descendants:

PERSONALITY & TEMPERAMENT

Core Traits:

Relationship with Humanity:

What Pleases Them:

What Angers Them:

WORSHIP

Primary Worshippers:

Temple Style:

Clergy:

Major Festivals:

Offerings:

Prayers:

DIVINE POWERS

Abilities:

Limitations:

How They Grant Power to Mortals:

Known Interventions in History:

MYTHOLOGY

Major Myths:
The Mirrors of Nimlye: Nimlye possessed five mirrors said to reveal the world's secrets to anyone who looked into them. Finding their power too dangerous, she scattered them across the earth, hoping no one would find them. One day, pirates stumbled upon an island of treasures that housed three of these mirrors. Thinking them merely shiny objects, they brought the mirrors aboard their ship. When nightfall came and moonlight struck the mirrors, the pirates were compelled to look within. What they saw was so disturbing that they went mad and killed each other—brother turned on brother, friend became foe. By morning, all were dead. The location of the remaining two mirrors has never been discovered.
The Mirror of Eternal Night: Centuries later, one of Nimlye's remaining mirrors surfaced in the court of a queen. It showed a world without sun and whispered ways to summon such darkness. The queen's attempt to use this knowledge plunged her kingdom into shadow.
The Garden of Unspoken Names: After the War of Gods I, the victorious new gods faced a question: what becomes of defeated divine beings? Gods cannot truly die, yet Mikani, Poaranji, and Renedin had been "slain." Nimlye created the Garden of Unspoken Names—a space outside time where the essence of dead gods exists in suspension. They are neither alive nor destroyed, but held in eternal potential. Nimlye tends the Garden alone. No other god may enter, for if a living god speaks a dead god's name within the Garden, that entity will resurrect regardless of consequence. Should Nimlye ever be killed or bound, the Garden would collapse, releasing all defeated divine beings simultaneously—an apocalyptic event.

Role in War of Gods:

Relationship with Saints:

CURRENT STATUS (By Era)

—

During Solis's Era:

During Crandona's Era:

By Minara's Era:

ROLE IN NARRATIVE

Direct Appearances:

Indirect Influence:

Characters Tied to Them:

NOTES

[NELLEBRIE]

[GODDESS OF DISASTERS]

Title: Goddess of Disasters

Domain:

Colors: Ash grey, blood red, charred black

Symbol: [None listed in this batch]

Sacred Animal: Vultures, Crows, Locusts

DIVINE CLASSIFICATION

**Category: Old God / New God Domain: Symbol:
Sacred Animal: Sacred Color: ORIGIN & NATURE**

**Creation/Birth: Relationship to Other Gods: True
Nature/Form: How They Manifest to Mortals(Their
Apperance): DIVINE FAMILY**

Parents:Paha (Goddess of Horses) + Razar (God of the Sun)

Siblings:

Children (Divine):

Mortal Descendants:

PERSONALITY & TEMPERAMENT

Core Traits:

Relationship with Humanity:

What Pleases Them:

What Angers Them:

WORSHIP

Primary Worshippers:

Temple Style:

Clergy:

Major Festivals:

Offerings:

Prayers:

DIVINE POWERS

Abilities:

Limitations:

How They Grant Power to Mortals:

Known Interventions in History:

MYTHOLOGY

Major Myths:

Role in War of Gods:

Relationship with Saints:

CURRENT STATUS (By Era)

During Solis's Era:

During Crandona's Era:

By Minara's Era:

ROLE IN NARRATIVE

Direct Appearances:

Indirect Influence:

Characters Tied to Them:

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[FINORE]

[GOD OF THE FORGE]

Title: God of the Forge and Craft

Domain: Labor, patience, creation, endurance, marriage (he who endures)

Colors: Iron grey, ember orange, charcoal black

Symbol: Hammer, anvil, chain

Sacred Animal: Badgers, Oxen

Major Myths (The Chain That Bound Renedin): During the War of Gods, Finore forged the chain that bound Renedin long enough for Nimlye to build the Garden.

The chain no longer exists; it was unmade when Renedin was moved to the Garden.

DIVINE CLASSIFICATION

Category: Old God / New God

Domain:

Symbol:

Sacred Animal:

Sacred Color:

ORIGIN & NATURE

Creation/Birth:

Relationship to Other Gods:

True Nature/Form:

How They Manifest to Mortals(Their Apperance):

DIVINE FAMILY

Parents:

Siblings:

Children (Divine):

Mortal Descendants:

PERSONALITY & TEMPERAMENT

Core Traits:

Relationship with Humanity:

What Pleases Them:

What Angers Them:

WORSHIP

Primary Worshippers:

Temple Style:

Clergy:

Major Festivals:

Offerings:

Prayers:

DIVINE POWERS

Abilities:

Limitations:

How They Grant Power to Mortals:

Known Interventions in History:

MYTHOLOGY

Major Myths: The Stone of Finore: Finore forged a stone capable of controlling all elements. Humans stole it and used it to wage terrible wars against one another. Horrified by what his creation had wrought, Finore shattered the stone and hid its fragments around the world, where they remain to this day.

Role in War of Gods:

Relationship with Saints:

CURRENT STATUS (By Era)

During Solis's Era:

During Crandona's Era:

By Minara's Era:

ROLE IN NARRATIVE

Direct Appearances:

Indirect Influence:

Characters Tied to Them:

NOTES

[SIELAPH] [GOD OF LIGHTNING]

Title: God of Lightning

Domain: Energy, sudden action, divine punishment, youth, impulsiveness

Colors: Electric blue, bright white, violet

Symbol: Lightning bolt, cracked stone, storm cloud

Sacred Animal: Jellyfish, Electric eels

Major Myths (The Mountain He Split): Once, Sielaph struck the same mountain seven times in frustration, trying to carve his name into stone. The mountain split. The scar remains, a canyon that floods every spring. Sielaph does not visit it.

DIVINE CLASSIFICATION

Category: Old God / New God

Domain:

Symbol:

Sacred Animal:

Sacred Color:

ORIGIN & NATURE

Creation/Birth:

Relationship to Other Gods:

True Nature/Form:

How They Manifest to Mortals(Their Apperance):

DIVINE FAMILY

Parents: Finore + Iswan

Siblings:

Children (Divine):

Mortal Descendants:

PERSONALITY & TEMPERAMENT

Core Traits:

Relationship with Humanity:

What Pleases Them:

What Angers Them:

WORSHIP

Primary Worshippers:

Temple Style:

Clergy:

Major Festivals:

Offerings:

Prayers:

DIVINE POWERS

Abilities:

Limitations:

How They Grant Power to Mortals:

Known Interventions in History:

MYTHOLOGY

Major Myths:

Role in War of Gods:

Relationship with Saints:

CURRENT STATUS (By Era)

During Solis's Era:

During Crandona's Era:

By Minara's Era:

ROLE IN NARRATIVE

Direct Appearances:

Indirect Influence:

Characters Tied to Them:

NOTES

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[Ekhasostio and Paxtino (Twin Gods in One Body)]

[THE TWIN GODS OF BALANCE]

DIVINE CLASSIFICATION

Category: Old God / New God

Domain: Peace/forgiveness & redemption /rebirth → Paxtino.

Vengeance/desire/chaos & Destruction

→ Ekhasostio.

Symbol:

Sacred Animal:

Sacred Color:

ORIGIN & NATURE

•

Creation/Birth:

Relationship to Other Gods:

True Nature/Form:

How They Manifest to Mortals(Their Apperance):

DIVINE FAMILY

Parents:
Siblings:
Children (Divine):
Mortal Descendants:

PERSONALITY & TEMPERAMENT

D
Core Traits:
Relationship with Humanity:
What Pleases Them:
What Angers Them:

WORSHIP

Primary Worshippers:
Temple Style:
Clergy:
Major Festivals:
Offerings:
Prayers:

DIVINE POWERS

Abilities:
Limitations:
How They Grant Power to Mortals:
Known Interventions in History:

MYTHOLOGY

Major Myths:
Role in War of Gods:
Relationship with Saints:

CURRENT STATUS (By Era)

During Solis's Era:
During Crandona's Era:

By Minara's Era:

ROLE IN NARRATIVE

Direct Appearances:

Indirect Influence:

Characters Tied to Them:

NOTES EKHASOSTIO AND PAXTINO - THE TWIN GODS IN ONE BODY (EXPANDED)

Ekhasostio and Paxtino are two souls sharing one body, born from Zopha's tears after Loart's death.

They are never simultaneously conscious. When Paxtino is dominant, Ekhasostio sleeps within their shared form, and vice versa. They experience each other's time through fragmented memories, like reading someone else's journal entries after the fact.

Transitions between them happen based on emotional state: peace, forgiveness, and rebirth call Paxtino forward; vengeance, desire, and chaos summon Ekhasostio.

Paxtino is gentle, patient, and genuinely kind - the god mortals want to pray to, the one who forgives transgressions and offers second chances. He is also melancholy beneath his kindness, knowing that every time he sleeps, his "brother" awakens and undoes his careful work.

Ekhasostio is intense, magnetic, and dangerous. He does not see himself as evil but as honest about mortal nature. People desire things they will not admit to wanting; Ekhasostio grants what they are too afraid to ask for aloud.

As "Soli" in mortal form during A Tale of Three Sisters (approximately 7, 200 — 7, 100BR, the post-War of Gods II era), Ekhasostio and Paxtino function as a merged entity - two aspects of one being who can separate or merge. Soli is the merged form controlling both aspects. This is the guise in which they meet Apharia. NOTE: This "Soli" is a completely different person from Emperor Solis Elias Patton. The twins are associated with the gates/world doors because their birth resonated with the weak points in Vapaz's barrier, making the doors navigable. But they do not literally stand guard there - that is a religious legend mortals created to explain why the Mystic Isles feel strange.

(See also: KEY WORDS AND TERMS - Gates/World Doors entry)

[ISWAN]

[GODDESS OF ALCHEMY]

Title: Goddess of Alchemy and Transformation

Domain: Magic, medicine, cunning, change, forbidden knowledge

Colors: Deep blue (Vikitsv connection), copper/bronze (alchemical metals), iridescent/shifting hues

Symbol: [None listed in this batch beyond animals — check if existing entry has symbols]

Sacred Animal: Snakes, Ravens

Role in War of Gods I: Betrayed Renedin mid-battle. She was fighting alongside him until she saw which way the war was turning. Her betrayal was the turning point: she revealed Renedin's weakness (that dreams require someone to dream them) to Nimlye, who used this knowledge to trap him.

Victory: Betrayal secured victory Failure: Lost Renedin forever; carries guilt

DIVINE CLASSIFICATION

Category: Old God / New God

Domain:

Symbol:

Sacred Animal:

Sacred Color:

ORIGIN & NATURE

Creation/Birth:

Relationship to Other Gods:

True Nature/Form:

How They Manifest to Mortals(Their Apperance):

DIVINE FAMILY

Parents:

Siblings:

Children (Divine):
Mortal Descendants:

PERSONALITY & TEMPERAMENT

Core Traits:
Relationship with Humanity:
What Pleases Them:
What Angers Them:

WORSHIP

Primary Worshippers:
Temple Style:
Clergy:
Major Festivals:
Offerings:
Prayers:

DIVINE POWERS

Abilities:
Limitations:
How They Grant Power to Mortals:
Known Interventions in History: The Verna bargain (creating mortal magic)

MYTHOLOGY

Major Myths: Iswan made the bargain with Grand Mage Verna that created mortal magic. Verna wished for the power to create spells, and Iswan was bound by the oath of Memiet to grant his wish after receiving a portion of his soul. This bargain is the origin of all magical ability in the world-making Iswan, whether intentionally or not, the divine source of mortal magic. The oath of Memiet states that if a god does not grant the wish of their follower after receiving their soul, the god shall cease to exist. This forced Iswan to grant Verna's wish despite the destruction it would cause.

The Lie That Saved the World: The commonly known "First Divine Law"-prohibiting mortal-immortal unions-is attributed to Vapaz. After Haxenylian died for loving a mortal, Iswan approached Vapaz with an ultimatum: "If you forbid love between mortals and immortals, you prevent future wars. But you also declare

love itself dangerous, and gods will grow cold. I offer an alternative: let mortals become something more." She proposed creating Saints-mortals granted temporary divine power without becoming gods-to satisfy mortals' desire for divine connection without producing demigod offspring who could challenge the pantheon. Vapaz agreed. (but Iswan had a secret purpose: she intended Saints to eventually replace gods entirely, believing mortals more adaptable and less prone to the pride that caused the War of the Gods. Some theologians argue the entire Saint system was Iswan's long-term plan to obsolete the divine order. This is a secret plan not part of the official myth that only the goddess Iswan knows.)

People of the Mountain: Those minor gods who believed Vapaz was wrong gathered atop a high mountain country called Vikistv. For centuries they waited, repopulating only amongst themselves. It wasn't until the great sorcerer Verna struck a bargain with Iswan: "Take my blood and soul, all that I have to divinity, and create-and we shall honor you, we shall never aspire to divinity again." Iswan agreed. (She had originally loved Renedin but took the side of the new gods during the war.) The magic she gave them corrupted their souls, made them neither divine nor mortal-they could not be hurt by normal means, but sun and fire wounded them greatly. Iswan convinced Vapaz to allow this, for he and his son controlled the sky, and he believed the People of the Mountain would be puppets because of their vulnerability to sunlight.

Role in War of Gods:

Relationship with Saints:

CURRENT STATUS (By Era)

During Solis's Era:

During Crandona's Era:

By Minara's Era:

ROLE IN NARRATIVE

-

Direct Appearances:

Indirect Influence:

Characters Tied to Them:

NOTES

RELIGIOUS ANOMALY: COELUM'S ATHEISM

STATUS

—Nation: Coelum ("The Forsaken Land") Religious Classification: Mostly atheistic

How Viewed by Neighbors: A tragic anomaly born of extreme suffering

ORIGIN

- Historical Cause: After enduring plagues, famines, and abandonment by its ruling class, the people of Coelum lost faith in the gods "who they say abandoned them to die."

Previous Practice: Coelum may have once followed the Pantheon (perhaps under Yuavekio they nominally worshiped like Gherci), but over time shrines fell into disuse.

Nature of Rejection: This atheism was born of despair rather than philosophy—a collective trauma response to extreme suffering. Many Coelumites came to view religion as a cruel joke.

CURRENT PRACTICE

-Festivals: Fewer festivals or holidays; only practical seasonal events (planting if any, harvest if any) observed without ceremony

Alternative Observance: Ancestor remembrance may have replaced formal worship

Attitude Toward Foreign Religion: Coelum's people didn't respect holy figures from other nations, sometimes causing friction when pilgrims passed through

SIGNIFICANCE

- Coelum stands as the only known atheistic society on the continent. Neighboring nations view it with pity rather than hostility—understanding the atheism as a symptom of catastrophic suffering rather than deliberate heresy.

RELIGIOUS PRACTICE IN AICRUAE

General Overview

-

Official Faith: The Circle of Eternal Light

Status: State-sponsored; all citizens expected to show reverence

Sub-religions: Leneyez, Rillic, and Barqeten (differ in practice but share the same pantheon)

Primary Deity: Razar (Sun God) — Aicruae's preeminent deity, reflected in the kingdom's flag and rituals

Religious Tolerance:

- Local or minority cults exist only discreetly
- Folk animism (spirits of trees, rivers, mountains) persists among peasants and highlanders
- Tolerated only if practices mix harmlessly with official rites
- Atheism is extremely rare and socially frowned upon
- Neighboring Coelum's near-atheism viewed as a tragic anomaly

Heretical Sects:

- The Order of the Pure Ones: Esoteric sect venerating human saints instead of gods
- Brutally suppressed in the Massacre of Light
- Survivors practice in secret; House Dajanyi among the few families still following openly

CLERGY HIERARCHY

Structure:

- Temple priests form a distinct class
- Each Pekna (triangular temple) has priests and priestesses led by a High Priest of that temple's deity
- Major shrines (especially Razar's temple in the capital) overseen by royal-appointed chief priests

Roles:

- Conducting rites and ceremonies

- Maintaining shrine grounds
- Counseling the laity
- Reporting moral crimes to authorities
- Arbitrating local disputes as temple elders

Lifestyle:

- Live modestly
- Generally do not marry (echoing celibate vows of the Pure Ones)

CLERGY ATTIRE

General Style: Simple and unadorned, consistent with Aicruae's cultural aversion to ostentation

Standard Vestments:

- Plain white or pale robes
- Subtle sun or triad motif permitted
- No elaborate clerical garb (no towering hats or bright colors)

Ceremonial Dress:

- Senior priests may carry incense burners or holy relics in public processions
- Otherwise blend with noble attire
- Celebrants of Razar may wear gold-trimmed stoles to symbolize sunlight

DAILY RITUAL & OBSERVANCE

Home Practice:

- Families make offerings at home altars
- Offerings given before meals
- Seeking omens from sacrificial signs

Community Worship:

- Local priests lead weekly or monthly community services at Peknas

- Liturgy involves chanting sacred verses, burning incense, and invoking the gods by name

State Ceremonies:

- High temples in the capital host enthronements, oaths, and state ceremonies
- The monarch is proclaimed to reign under Razar's light

Fasting & Observance:

- Fast on solemn holidays
- Breaking fasts may incur communal scorn
- Religious observance woven into daily custom

FESTIVALS & HOLY DAYS

Festival Calendar: Rich with religious celebrations tied to seasonal cycles, equinoxes, and royal anniversaries

Major Festivals:

ALLAN'S BLESSING (Spring)

- Planting festival honoring Allan, goddess of nature
- Priests consecrate seeds
- Villages feast for fertility
 - Marks the beginning of the agricultural season

SUN SOLSTICE (Mid-Summer)

- Aicruae's grandest holiday
- Temples of Razar light great bonfires
- People pray for abundance under the ever-bright summer sun
- Kingdom-wide celebration

FEAST OF PLENTY (Autumn) - Harvest festival giving thanks to the entire Pantheon - Each god and goddess receives offerings in a communal temple

ceremony - Features competitions in music and poetry - Enormous quantities of food and wine enjoyed by all - As much cultural as religious in nature

FESTIVAL OF VAPAZ (Midwinter) - More solemn celebration honoring Vapaz the Sky-King - Quiet vigils held under the stark winter night sky - Candles lit in triangular lanterns (echoing the Pekna temple shape) - Prayers offered for guidance through hardship - Belief that Vapaz's firmament watches over mortals even in darkest days.

CIRCLE OF LIGHT PAGEANT (Annual, Urban) - Important cultural-religious event held in Lajazer and major cities - Commemorates the founding of the Circle of Eternal Light faith Representatives carry icons of all twelve deities through streets in grand procession - Procession ends at central Pekna temple for joint prayers - Symbolizes the unity of the gods - Draws visitors from across the kingdom and foreign pilgrims

Other Observances:

- Equinox celebrations (spring and autumn)
- Royal anniversaries and commemorations
- Harvest festivals in autumn

SACRED SITES

The Cidet ("The Temple of the Gods"):

- Holiest pilgrimage site in relative location to Aicruae
- Receives 9 million pilgrims yearly
- Contains the Hall of Twelve, the Room of Glory, and the Hero's Hall
- Aicruae maintains "unofficial rights" to its protection and access
- Well-maintained pilgrim road from Lajazer, patrolled by Aicruan guards

Peknas (Local Temples):

- Triangular temples serving as community religious centers
- Found throughout Aicruae's towns and villages
- Each dedicated to a specific deity

Capital Temple:

- Razar's temple in Lajazer
- Overseen by royal-appointed chief priests
- Site of state ceremonies including enthronements

PAXTINO

Title: God of Peace, Rebirth, Mercy, and Redemption

Domain:

Colors: Soft white, pale blue, pale gold (dawn colors), soft rose

Symbol: Olive branch

Sacred Animal: Doves, Lambs

EKHASOSTIO

Title: God of Vengeance, Desire, and Destruction

Domain:

Colors: Deep crimson, black, dark purple

Symbol:

Sacred Animal: Scorpions, Black dogs

SAINT [NAME]

[Ordinal Number] Saint | The [Epithet]

DIVINE STATUS

Ordinal: [1st through 13th]

Patron Of:

Blessed By (God):

Symbol/Iconography:

Holy Day:

MORTAL LIFE

Birth Name:

Born: [Date] | [Location]

Died: [Date] | [Circumstances]

Ethnicity:

Social Origin:

PATH TO SAINTHOOD

How They Were Chosen:

Age When Blessed:

Miracles Attributed:

Major Deeds:

PERSONALITY & CHARACTER

Core Traits:

Virtues:

Flaws (If Any):

How They Related to Common People:

HISTORICAL IMPACT

Era Active:

Political Involvement:

Religious Reforms:

Legacy:

WORSHIP & VENERATION

How They're Prayed To:

Offerings/Rituals:

Who Particularly Venerates Them:

Common Prayers/Invocations:

BURIAL & RELICS

Burial Location:

Known Relics:

Pilgrimage Sites:

ROLE IN NARRATIVE

Mentioned In (Books):

Relevance to Plot:

Characters Who Reference Them:

NOTES

THE GODS OF OLD

(Defeated in War of Gods I)

THE FOUR BROTHERS

-

The original four gods, born of the same song in the beginning of time.

HAXENYLIAN - God of Protection and Wisdom

- Third of the four brothers
- Fell in love with a mortal woman (Lady Gaialana), producing the first New Gods (Vapaz and Zopha)
- Died in War of Gods I defending his children and the newer gods
- His son Vapaz became the first King of the Gods after his death

MIKANI - God of War and Order

- Led the offensive against the New Gods in War of Gods I
- Detested the union between Haxenylian and Lady Gaialana
- Turned his brothers Poaranji and Renedin against Haxenylian
- Defeated by Vapaz in battle

POARANJI - God of Strength and Sailors

- Controlled the seas during War of Gods I
- Defeated (drowned by Zopha's grief during battle)

RENEDIN - God of Dreams and the Eternal Plane

- Assassinated Lady Gaialana by trapping her in an eternal dream
- Fought through nightmares and psychological warfare
- Survived War of Gods I but was eventually imprisoned in the Garden of Unspoken Names

MINOR OLD GOD

LOART - God of Wealth

- Minor Old God who defected to help the New Gods
- Married to Zopha; father of Paxtino and Ekhasostio
- Died in War of Gods I securing the New Gods' victory

DIVINE LAWS

FIRST DIVINE LAW

Following Haxenylian's death, Vapaz set in motion a divine law prohibiting a mortal and an immortal from falling in love and having a child.

This law is the origin of the Saint system-because gods cannot produce divine children with mortals, saints became adopted children for the gods instead.

SECOND DIVINE LAW

Any God or Goddess that disobeys Vapaz will die the same way any mortal would.

THE THIRTEEN SAINTS -

1. ALIIRUSK - "The Godly Saint"

Divine Status

- Ordinal: First Saint
- Blessed By: Finore
- Epithets/Nicknames: "The Godly Saint"

Mortal Life

- Birth: 18,765BR
- Death: 18,740 BR (aged 25)

- Origin: Unknown region
- Family: Father, mother, and one-year-old child (all deceased shortly after his death)

Path to Sainthood Aliirusk was the first human to be gifted with the power of a saint. He was endlessly loved by both the gods and humans, though he was also naive. He dedicated his short life to serving the gods and protecting humanity, stepping into the midst of wars to promote peace.

Personality & Character Kind, sweet, and loving. Always willing to do whatever it took to bring about peace.

Historical Impact

- First human saint, establishing the precedent for all who followed
- Died at the Battle of Wena while promoting peace
- His death caused the gods to punish humanity for causing his demise
- Finore descended to Earth to retrieve his body and created the legendary weapon Allironek in his honor
- His family's deaths following his own became known as the Tragedy of Enaner (humans falsely blamed his family for the misfortune, despite them not receiving the gods' punishment)

Worship & Veneration Remembered as "The Godly Saint" for being the first and most beloved by the gods.

Burial & Relics

- Burial Location: Kingdom of the Gods (first of four saints buried there)
- Associated Relic: Allironek (legendary weapon created by Finore)

Role in Narrative [To be determined based on story needs]

2. BURA - "Mother Greatest"

Divine Status

- Ordinal: Second Saint
- Blessed By: Vapaz (first of two saints blessed by this god)
- Epithets/Nicknames: "Mother Greatest"

Mortal Life

- Birth: 17, 600BR
- Death: 17,540 BR (aged 60)
- Origin: Unknown region
- Family: Unknown

Path to Sainthood Bura led an ordinary life, seeking only comfort until she was gifted her powers by the god Vapaz. She is one of only two saints to receive blessings from Vapaz.

Personality & Character Creative, organizational, and trustworthy.

Historical Impact

- Created thirty cities
- Established a vast irrigation system
- Built schools that educated girls-a groundbreaking achievement at the time
- The girls she taught later assisted her in developing cities and towns across the world, though maintaining their unity proved challenging

Worship & Veneration Affectionately nicknamed "Mother Greatest" for her contributions to civilization and women's education.

Burial & Relics

- Burial Location: Not specified (not among the four buried in the Kingdom of the Gods)
- Associated Relics: None specified

Role in Narrative [To be determined based on story needs]

3. GALAMMA - "The Lost One"

Divine Status

- Ordinal: Third Saint
- Blessed By: Sielaph
- Epithets/Nicknames: "The Lost One"

Mortal Life

- Birth: 15,870BR
- Death: 15,852 BR (aged 18)
- Origin: Unknown region
- Family: Widowed mother

Path to Sainthood Born during a heavily religious time when people suspected others of being demons (not actual demons, but religious psychosis was prevalent-the term "demon" was used for heretics who did not show faith in the gods). She received her gifts from the god Sielaph. Many believe she was able to communicate directly with her god, and that Galamma and Sielaph were very close.

Personality & Character Outgoing, adventurous, and easygoing.

Historical Impact Her tragic death became a cautionary tale about prejudice and jumping to conclusions. Due to a misunderstanding, she was thought to be a "demon" and was kidnapped and executed.

Worship & Veneration Nicknamed "The Lost One" due to her tragic, unjust death.

Burial & Relics

- Burial Location: Kingdom of the Gods (second of four saints buried there)
- Associated Relics: None specified

Role in Narrative [To be determined based on story needs]

4. DORTHARGEL - "God's Favorite"

Divine Status

- Ordinal: Fourth Saint
- Blessed By: Nellebrie
- Epithets/Nicknames: "God's Favorite"

Mortal Life

- Birth: 13,052BR
- Death: 13,020 BR (aged 32)
- Origin: Unknown region
- Family: Unknown (had family who buried her)

Path to Sainthood Dorthargel developed her powers closer to the end of her life. Nellebrie chose her because she had similar hair to hers-hair is said to be a reflection of one's soul, and Dorthargel was the first human Nellebrie saw with that hair color. Nellebrie and Dorthargel often played together and sang songs with one another. Though Dorthargel never actually saw Nellebrie, she thought of the goddess as a mother.

Personality & Character Modest, generous, and loyal.

Historical Impact Her relationship with Nellebrie became one of the greatest reminders of the gods' love for the saints. When Dorthargel died of illness, Nellebrie blamed herself and in her grief destroyed cities, caused earthquakes, and asked several gods to kill her.

Worship & Veneration Nicknamed "God's Favorite" for the deep, maternal love Nellebrie held for her.

Burial & Relics

- Burial Location: Mortal burial site (not in the Kingdom of the Gods-Nellebrie did not want to disturb her rest due to "selfishness" since her family had already buried her)

- Associated Relics: None specified

Role in Narrative [To be determined based on story needs]

5. EREN - "The Wrong Choice"

Divine Status

- Ordinal: Fifth Saint
- Blessed By: Nimlye (Queen of the Gods)
- Epithets/Nicknames: "The Wrong Choice"

Mortal Life

- Birth: 12,467BR
- Death: 12,441 BR (aged 26)
- Origin: Unknown region
- Family: Unknown

Path to Sainthood Blessed by the queen of the gods, the goddess Nimlye. Despite this honor, Eren led an idealistic life, ignoring his duties as a saint and venturing out into the world.

Personality & Character Considered foolish by most. He wasn't generally a bad person—just young and not versed in the ways of the world. This is why many believe Nimlye favored him; some say he was more favored than Nimlye's own son.

Historical Impact

- First example of humans disapproving of who the gods make saints
- Because he ignored his duties, he was hunted down by humans and died after suffering countless blows to his head

Worship & Veneration Nicknamed "The Wrong Choice" as an example of the gods choosing poorly.

Burial & Relics

- Burial Location: The Mirrors of Nimlye-Nimlye tried to get the gods to agree to bury him in the Kingdom of the Gods, but they deemed him unworthy. Instead, she created a mirror and placed his body inside it, then had Finore refine the mirror into a necklace that she wears at all times.
- Associated Relics: Nimlye's mirror necklace containing his body

Role in Narrative [To be determined based on story needs]

6. ARGELLON - "The Second Choice"

Divine Status

- Ordinal: Sixth Saint
- Blessed By: Paha
- Epithets/Nicknames: "The Second Choice"

Mortal Life

- Birth: 11,002BR
- Death: 10,952 BR (aged 50)
- Origin: Unknown region
- Family: Older brother (original intended recipient of blessing, died in war)

Path to Sainthood Nicknamed "The Second Choice" because he wasn't supposed to receive the goddess Paha's gift. The gift was originally intended for his older brother, but when his brother died suddenly in war, Paha gave her gift to Argellon instead.

Personality & Character Headstrong, bold, and dedicated.

Historical Impact

- Created the first official temple to the goddess Paha (his older brother is buried beneath a statue of the goddess inside this temple)

- Created the idea of a moral code-the Code of Esa, which has been essential in creating many social orders and is still used to uphold order

Worship & Veneration Remembered for establishing the Code of Esa and the first temple to Paha.

Burial & Relics

- Burial Location: Buried beside his brother in the first temple of the goddess Paha
- Associated Relics: The Code of Esa

Role in Narrative [To be determined based on story needs]

7. SIRIANDE - "Sirianne the Unlucky"

Divine Status

- Ordinal: Seventh Saint
- Blessed By: Zopha
- Epithets/Nicknames: "Sirianne the Unlucky"

Mortal Life

- Birth: 10,567BR
- Death: 10,533 BR (aged 34)
- Origin: Daughter of a local fisher, spent much time near the sea
- Family: Father (fisher), son Ritav (who poisoned her)

Path to Sainthood As a child playing near the sea, her toy flew into the water. When she went to retrieve it, she nearly drowned but was saved by the goddess Zopha, who felt sorry for her. After saving her, Zopha gifted her powers, making her a saint.

Personality & Character Described in historical texts as a wonderful mother and saint.

Historical Impact

- Constructed several dams
- Created the Yerian Laws, meant to grant protection for women (ranging from material laws to land ownership)
- Her son Ritav betrayed and poisoned her (she knew he was trying to poison her but accepted the poison anyway). Many suspect his reasons were related to power.
- Her final requests to Zopha: (1) spare her son, believing he was merely corrupted by the will of men-Zopha agreed but took away his ability to speak so he could never ask for forgiveness; (2) be buried amongst men, not amongst the gods

Worship & Veneration Nicknamed "Siriande the Unlucky" because if she had borne a better son, she may have lived longer.

Burial & Relics

- Burial Location: Amongst mortals (by her own request)
- Ritav committed suicide five years after her death after suffering extreme madness. Zopha covered his grave in water to disturb his rest so he may never know peace.
- Associated Relics: The Yerian Laws

Role in Narrative [To be determined based on story needs]

8. NAIRAN - "Little Princess"

Divine Status

- Ordinal: Eighth Saint
- Blessed By: Allan
- Epithets/Nicknames: "Little Princess"

Mortal Life

- Birth: 10,012BR
- Death: 9,983 BR (aged 29)
- Origin: First saint born to an affluent family; father was a powerful leader of a small town
- Family: Father (town leader), three young daughters

Path to Sainthood First saint to be born to an affluent family. She had never known hardship and did not get her gift by being extraordinary or having a trait that set her apart. She was simply in the right place at the right time. Her carriage broke down in a forest, and while roaming to pass the time, she stumbled upon a wounded deer. This deer was actually the goddess Allan, wounded from an attack by humans. Allan was suspicious of Nairan's flashy nature at first, but grew to like her when Nairan took off her coat to cover her. Allan gifted her the blessing soon after.

Personality & Character Generous, compassionate (willing to sacrifice her own comfort for a stranger/animal in need).

Historical Impact

- Created a system to help root out corruption within the appointed government
- Created a movement for science that helped create and modify medicine
- Her death is said to be the reason why willow trees bloom in Gherci (she is believed to have been from that area before it became Gherci)

Worship & Veneration Nicknamed "Little Princess" for being the first saint from wealth rather than hardship.

Burial & Relics

- Burial Location: Not specified
- Death: Died surrounded by her three young daughters from complications birthing her last child
- Associated Relics: None specified

Role in Narrative [To be determined based on story needs]

9. KARNIODE - "The Gentle One"

Divine Status

- Ordinal: Ninth Saint
- Blessed By: Widely believed to be Zopha (some texts mention she could part oceans at will)
- Epithets/Nicknames: "The Gentle One"

Mortal Life

- Birth: 9,365BR
- Death: 9,351 BR (aged 14)
- Origin: Unknown village, possibly one of the Four Territories (Aseraga, Baeistic, Urdeio, or Feacener) that would form Pireayena
- Family: Unknown (some myth suggests she was the illegitimate child of Zopha and a mortal fisherman named Qanyaso)

Path to Sainthood Not much is known about Karniode's life despite her being born during a time when history had begun being recorded. She received her powers at age 13 and was born blind. For many years, people didn't believe she existed or thought her a myth because she was not buried officially, and her name and face had been burned out of almost all history books from that period.

Personality & Character The nickname "The Gentle One" may have reflected her position within her society.

Historical Impact The main mystery is her death-some say she stumbled off a cliff, others say she was pushed by a family member with ill intent. After her death, her village was completely devastated by a tsunami and many villagers died. Survivors only spoke of her in passing.

Worship & Veneration Called "The Gentle One" by survivors of her village. Some give her honorifics like "Karniode of Aseraga," "Karniode of Baeistic," "Karniode of Urdeio," or "Karniode of Feacener" based on speculation about her origin.

Burial & Relics

- Burial Location: Kingdom of the Gods (third of four saints buried there)
- Associated Relics: None specified

Role in Narrative [To be determined based on story needs]

10. MALIGN - "The Sacred Knight"

Divine Status

- Ordinal: Tenth Saint
- Blessed By: Finore (many believe Finore chose him because they shared similar values)
- Epithets/Nicknames: "The Sacred Knight"

Mortal Life

- Birth: 9,323BR
- Death: 9,305 BR (aged 18)
- Origin: Unknown region
- Family: Sister (died trying to defend him)

Path to Sainthood Gifted his abilities by the god Finore. Believed to have been chosen because he and Finore shared similar values.

Personality & Character Champion of equality, dedicated advocate for women's rights, believer in free speech.

Historical Impact

- Champion of economic equality-went as far as drinking nothing but salt water for several days so people could recognize the wealth gap
- Dedicated champion for women's rights; promoted women to high positions despite opposition
- Improved upon the Yerian Laws to meet his time's standards

- Helped spread the idea of free speech and the press, letting people talk about him as they saw fit
- Famous quotes:
- "If you have no enemies, then you have no friends, for enemies will always find a way into your company, claiming they are your friends."
- The Three Lines of Sin: "The essence of human existence encompasses three fundamental imperatives: the necessity to live, the imperative to create, and the inevitability of destruction."
- Killed during a holy celebration by his political enemies; his sister died trying to defend him

Worship & Veneration Saint Duri (the next saint) was obsessed with him and worshipped him like an idol, believing he was taken before his time. She spent her entire life trying to spread his beliefs.

Burial & Relics

- Burial Location: Not specified (not among the four in the Kingdom of the Gods, as Duri was the last)
- Associated Relics: The Three Lines of Sin (his philosophical quote)

Role in Narrative [To be determined based on story needs]

11. DURI - "The Mother of Gherci" / "Duri the Wise" / "Queen of the People" / "The True Saint"

Divine Status

- Ordinal: Eleventh Saint
- Blessed By: Allan (who believed Duri was destined for greatness)
- Epithets/Nicknames: The Mother of Gherci, Duri the Wise, Queen of the People, The True Saint (only saint with multiple nicknames)

Mortal Life

- Birth: 8, 747BR
- Death: 8,670 BR (aged 77-longest-living saint)
- Origin: Founder of Gherci
- Family: Unknown

Path to Sainthood Blessed by the goddess Allan, who believed Duri was destined for greatness.

Personality & Character Historical texts describe her as cold and standoffish, but her diaries revealed a softer side. She wrote down the name of every man she had killed in detail and wrote "I am sorry" by each of their names.

Historical Impact

- Only saint to have founded, created, and ruled an entire country (Gherci)
- Considered the most powerful and wisest of the Saints
- Believed highly in the gods and divine order; built monuments of all previous saints around Gherci as walls, with her own statue in the center (visibly smaller than the others)
- Most accomplishments among all saints:
 - Created several military strategies
 - Established an official legal court
 - Constructed an international trade route
 - Created Tanya's (public hospitals)
 - Spent most of her life on the battlefield fighting for her country
 - Never lost a battle; true upholder of Honor
 - Obsessed with Saint Malign and worshipped him like an idol; spent her entire life trying to spread his beliefs

Worship & Veneration Quote: "The kind ones die early, leaving behind the worst of us." Quote: "To have existed for as long as I have, one must ultimately reconcile with those who once stood as their adversaries, even if they remain oblivious to

such gestures of peace. For it is the divine, in their omniscience, who observes the full spectrum of our deeds and moral failings."

Burial & Relics

- Burial Location: Kingdom of the Gods (fourth and last of the saints buried there, honored for all her accomplishments)
- Associated Relics: Statues of saints around Gherci, her diaries

Role in Narrative [To be determined based on story needs]

12. RERON - "The Ender of Worlds"

Divine Status

- Ordinal: Twelfth Saint
- Blessed By: Vapaz (second of two saints blessed by this god)
- Epithets/Nicknames: "The Ender of Worlds"
- Status: Considered a taboo saint-depending on who tells the story, he was or was not a saint

Mortal Life

- Birth: 7,450 BR
- Death: 7,402 BR (aged 48)
- Origin: Unknown region
- Family: Mother Mevi (hanged as a witch), wife (killed by captors), eldest daughter (killed by captors), youngest child (hidden in Equateiy, never seen again)

Path to Sainthood His mother was accused of being a witch and temptress who seduced the god Vapaz (affairs with gods were extremely taboo). She was hanged, and young Reron was left as a beggar. He manifested his abilities at age 24 . Captors used his wife and children to threaten him into performing his duties as a saint. Eventually, they killed his wife and eldest daughter. Reron escaped with

his youngest child and hid her in a surrounding village in Equateiy, never seeing her again.

Personality & Character Controversial-some sympathize with him, saying he only killed and destroyed to avenge his family; others say he abused his power for petty revenge.

Historical Impact

- Destroyed villages and killed many people at will with his abilities, believing the people of his world had wronged him
- Died at the Battle of Relirian after being ambushed by the same people who killed his wife and child
- Made it so no one made it out of the battle alive

Worship & Veneration Controversial figure-viewed as either a tragic avenger or a power-abusing monster depending on the storyteller.

Burial & Relics

- Burial Location: Not specified (not among the four in the Kingdom of the Gods)
- Associated Relics: None specified

Role in Narrative [To be determined based on story needs]

13. HARNUA KULIO - "The Infamous Thirteenth Saint"

Divine Status

- Ordinal: Thirteenth and Final Saint
- Blessed By: Nellebrie
- Epithets/Nicknames: The Infamous Thirteenth Saint
- Status: Controversial; second only to Reron in terms of infamy

Mortal Life

- Birth: 7,251 BR (eleventh month, 19th day)
- Death: Date of official execution (burned at the stake)
- Origin: First daughter of Count Kulio
- Family: House Kulio (Esterica Kulio died drinking poison meant for Emperor Solis)

Path to Sainthood The full story of her life is in the book "A Tale of A Thousand Songs." In brief: As a child, she fell for Orcus Emere Patton and, over years of war and privation, her devotion curdled from consoling saint to zealotry.

Personality & Character Her love became obsession, then zealotry.

Historical Impact

- After Orcus's death, she bargained with Nellebrie and tried to kill Emperor Solis with Ilkai (a god-killing herb)
- Esterica Kulio drank the poisoned cup instead and died
- Solis captured Harnua and burned her at the stake
- Before the flames took her, she spent the last of her saintly power to raise a second moon in Orcus's honor
- Her death canonized her as the controversial thirteenth saint
- Reshaped the calendar by inaugurating the 40 -day thirteenth month, Agarisono

Worship & Veneration The last saint ever recorded. Her legacy is tied to the creation of the thirteenth month.

Burial & Relics

- Burial Location: Not specified (executed by burning)
- Associated Relics: The second moon (created with her final power)

Role in Narrative Central figure in "A Tale of A Thousand Songs"

HARNUA KULIO - THE THIRTEENTH AND FINAL SAINT

-

Full Name: Harnua Kulio

Title: "The Great Tragedy"

Saint Number: Thirteenth (and final)

Blessed By: Nellebrie, Goddess of Disasters

Date of Blessing: ~7,241 BR (age 10)

Date of Death: 7,214 BR (burned at the stake by Solis)

Month Created by Death: Agarisono (40 days - the 13th month)

Saintly Powers:

- Blessed with divine abilities by Nellebrie
- Specific powers: [TBD]
- Final Act: With her dying breath, Harnua raised a second moon in honor of Orcus. This moon is bigger than the one named after Solis and spins three times faster, always beating Solis's moon in rotation.

Restrictions of Sainthood:

[TBD - the pasted content mentions Harnua was "forced into solitude" and could only see Orcus twice a year. Confirm whether this is a formal restriction of sainthood (like a chastity/isolation requirement) or a social/political constraint imposed by the church.]

Why Saints Stopped After Harnua:

Harnua was the proof of concept the gods feared. She raised a moon with her dying breath - that's approaching divine territory, not saint-level power. The gods saw what Iswan's system could produce and collectively decided, without ever formally acknowledging it, to simply stop creating saints.

It wasn't a decree from Vapaz or a divine law. It was a silent agreement born of fear. The gods tell themselves mortals became "unworthy" after Harnua's zealotry and attempted regicide, but the truth is simpler: they saw what saints could become and chose self-preservation.

Different religious texts offer different explanations mortals became too corrupt, the gods grew distant, humanity must prove itself worthy again - but none of these are true. The gods simply got scared and went quiet.

This fits the series' theme that divine law is trauma fossilized into policy. The gods don't reform; they react.

Cross-references:

- HARNUA KULIO (In Story Characters)
- AGARISONO (Key Words and Terms)
- ILKAI (Key Words and Terms)
- ORCUS EMERE PATTON (In Story Characters)
- All 12 previous Saints (Religion - Saints section)

The Three Religions

The Brotherhood of Westwinds

Creation and Reason for Creation: The Brotherhood of Westwinds was established in 9,360 BR. This religion was founded during a very religious time when religious tolerance was very rare. Members of the religion believe in the absolute worship of the gods of old. This belief often leads them to have conflicts with the Circle of Eternal Light because the Circle of Eternal Light believes in both the worship of the gods of new and old.

Gods of Worship: The Brotherhood of Westwinds is a polytheistic religion created by Oleahak the Unseen. The brotherhood focuses heavily on the worship of the gods of old, specifically the gods of old that died in the great war of the gods. The gods of old were gods fighting to preserve the old ways rather than embrace the coming of a new generation. These gods include the god of war and order Mikani, the god of strength and sailors Poaranji, the god of dreams and the eternal plane Renedin, and the god of protection and wisdom Haxenylan.

God's Relationship With Humans/Followers: The gods of old detested mortals and saw them as lesser beings only created for their enjoyment and well-being. The gods of old were cruel and vicious in their treatment of mortals, only extending sympathy and respect amongst others of equal standing as them.

Religious Beliefs: Followers of this religion believe in the idea that there are three main keys to life and that by maintaining and actively upholding these keys, in

death you are granted salvation (the ability to enter the kingdom of the gods). The first key is the worshipping of the gods and carrying out divine order in their name. The second key is worshipping one's ancestors and honoring them before honoring oneself. The third key is maintaining the balance between the realm of the gods and the mortal realm in sacrifice and offerings.

Founding Story: This brotherhood was established roughly six thousand years after the defeat of the gods of old during the great war of the gods. The legend goes that Renedin came to Oleahak in his dreams and showed him a prophecy of demons invading the world and setting it aflame. The god Renedin is said to have warned Oleahak that soon the sins of humanity would become so unforgivable that the gods would abandon them. After receiving this dream, Oleahak assembled a brotherhood of men who sought to restore order to the world.

Though this is the story the followers of the Brotherhood of Westwinds believe, over the centuries debate has risen over its soundness. The debate about the accuracy of Oleahak's dream is mainly because Oleahak had the dream while running a high fever and on the brink of death. Alongside that fact, over the years there have been some historians who heard whispers that it wasn't Oleahak who received the prophecy but his wife Tiaeraer. Some say Oleahak took the prophecy from her and changed it to fit his narrative. The original prophecy is said to have been that a god shall bring forth the end of men and the humans would be the ones to abandon the gods, not the other way around.

How This Religion is Viewed: This religion, while not being the oldest religion amongst the other religions present, is considered extremely outdated, with only five percent of the world population actively practicing it. This is mainly because there is no official temple of worship for this religion and a lot of their activities involve traveling from place to place. The Brotherhood of Westwinds is seen as a very extremist religion focusing heavily on a male-centric belief system.

Religious Text - The Tome of Renedin: The brotherhood of Westwinds' teachings are followed and closely observed using the Tome of Renedin. The Tome of Renedin is a book that describes the dream the god gave the creator of this religion and why the gods of old must be respected and worshipped over the gods of new.

Excerpts from the Tome:

1. "As the father precedes and guides the son, so does the old yield to the new. In the presence of sovereignty, let one bow in reverence before the king and bestow a gentle kiss upon the hand of the prince, acknowledging both the wisdom of the past and the promise of the future." - Line of Observation, Section 1
2. "Inevitably, chaos shall arise to cleanse the world, sweeping away those of ill character and leaving only the virtuous and wise. The fate of deceivers is to encounter a justice both equitable and inexorable, their memory fading as the relentless passage of time endures." - Line of Observation, Section 15
3. "So it was that lightning struck down the transgressor - the one who spoke falsehoods in the name of the gods, driven by malice and injuring the beloved creations of divine affection." Spoken Line, Section 12

The Gods of Old Ranked in Order of Power:

1. Renedin - Because people were the most defenseless while they were sleeping around this time due to conflict, wars, etc., people couldn't defend themselves in their sleep, so they saw Renedin as the ultimate protector.
2. Mikani - In 30,000 BR war was always happening, sometimes in smaller fights or brawls or in all-out bloodbaths, so naturally the god of war was one of the most powerful.
3. Poaranji — Was ranked third because strength was needed for war (both mental and physical strength).
4. Haxenylian - Was lesser known than his brothers because while everyone wanted protection during this time, it was better to have luck and strength.

The Circle of Eternal Light

Date of Creation and Purpose/Reason for Creation: The Circle of Eternal Light was founded in 14,271 BR. The circle was founded by Aryanara and Veketa, twin sisters who believed in the merging of old and new.

Sub-Religions: The Circle of Eternal Light has three main sub-religions, each with its own way of worshipping the gods of old and new. The sub-religions are called Leneyez, Rilic, and Barqeten.

Leneyez: The sub-religion named Leneyez believes in the sacrifice of both people and farm life to the two sets of gods during monthly prayers and festivals. The believers of Leneyez believe that by sacrificing, they maintain both the physical and spiritual well-being of the gods.

Rilic: The believers of Rilic believe in the worship of the gods solely through prayer. These believers pray five times a day for usually forty minutes at a time. Believers of Rilic believe that they were put on this planet to fuel the gods' strength and give them a stronger tether to the physical/mortal world.

Barqeten: The last and final sub-religion in the Circle of Eternal Light is called Barqeten. Followers of this religion believe that by simply existing, they are worshipping the gods. The followers of Barqeten care a lot about both their physical and mental wellness. They believe that because they were created by god, they should do the most to take care of themselves and others to make the gods proud.

Core Belief: Though the religion is split up into three sub-religions, the main function of this religion centers around the belief in the equality of both the gods of old and new. The core belief of this religion is that despite the age, the two sets of gods should be worshipped equally. The Circle of Eternal Light is a very peaceful religion, not focusing too much on traditional values despite its age of creation, and instead hoping to unite everyone under worship.

Place of Worship: The followers of this religion pray inside triangle-shaped temples called Peknas. While the outside appearance of Peknas is triangular in shape, the inside is a more circular shape.

Countries That Follow This Religion: Many countries follow some variation of this religion, including Aicruae, Gherci, Pireaynea, and Coelum.

Religious Text - Zyrathia (Name Meaning: Knowledge of Songs):

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The Order of the Pure Ones

Origin and Founders: The Order of the Pure Ones was founded around 8,600BR, emerging out of the massacre that followed the deaths of early saints. Unlike the other religions, it rejects worship of gods entirely and venerates saints as “pure vessels.” This is why its followers were targeted by King Viake in the Massacre of Light. According to legend, a devout woman named Naya of Enaner, a descendant of Saint Aliirusk’s murdered family, gathered survivors and wrote the Book of Purity.

Beliefs: The Pure Ones teach that humanity must become holy enough to replace the gods. Their central tenet is the “Four Abstinences”: abstaining from violence, from consuming animal flesh, from reproduction outside designated holy unions, and from magical practices. They view the gods as cruel (echoing the gods of old’s contempt for mortals) and believe the saints proved that mortals can surpass divinity.

Relationship with Gods/Humans: Members secretly mourn the saints slaughtered in the Massacre of Light and hold weekly vigils. They emphasize communal charity and pacifism; they will not fight except in defense of children. This pacifism partly explains why they were persecuted.

Rituals and Text - The Book of Purity: The Book of Purity contains moral codes reminiscent of Argellon's Code of Esa but stricter: e.g., "Purify your tongue; a word can murder as surely as a blade." Pilgrims journey to hidden sanctuaries to meditate on each saint's life.

How the Religion is Viewed: Many in power view it as heretical and dangerous because it denies the gods; the Brotherhood of Westwinds calls its followers traitors, and the Circle of Eternal Light calls them misguided. Nonetheless, its numbers grow among peasants and artisans because its teachings offer hope without divine hierarchy.

Noirta and the First Song

Before gods, before mortals, before the world was the world or the sea was the sea, there was only Noirta. Noirta is the first song-not a song sung by anyone, not a song created for a purpose. It simply is, and always has been, and always will be. It is the fabric of time and power, the endless cycle of souls and energy, the force that makes existence possible. Death is but a pause in a very long song.

There is no creator deity in this cosmology. No grand architect. No parent of the gods. Just the Song, cycling eternally, and the patterns that emerged from it.

The Crystallization of the Old Gods

The four brothers did not have parents. They were not born in any conventional sense. They crystallized from Noirta as the cosmos's first and most powerful expressions-like dew forming on grass at dawn. Inevitable. Emergent. Uncreated. The Song played, and from that playing, consciousness condensed. The universe had needs, and those needs took shape.

The brothers know this about themselves. They are aware that they emerged from the same primordial chord, that they are fragments of a single original response to existence.

Each brother crystallized in response to something the early cosmos required: Renedin emerged because existence needed a space between states-dreams, the threshold between waking and sleeping, between reality and possibility. Mikani crystallized because the growing cosmos needed structure, law, boundaries. Without him, reality would have remained formless potential. Poaranji emerged

because things existed that could be destroyed, and the cosmos needed a force that could push back, resist, endure. Haxenylian came last, because once the others existed, the cosmos needed someone to protect what had been created.

The Original Harmony

In the beginning, the four brothers existed in balance. Their domains complemented rather than competed-structure and force, dreams and protection, each playing its part in a cosmos that hummed with purpose. They were like instruments in a chord: distinct voices creating something greater than any individual note. This harmony was not enforced. It was natural. The Song played through them, and they played through each other, and the cosmos was whole.

What Mortals Changed (~ 30, 000 BR)

The brothers' harmony lasted until mortals learned to believe. Around 30, 000BR, during an age of constant war, mortal belief began to shift the fabric of reality itself. The gods had always drawn power from Noirta, but mortal worship created something new-a feedback loop where belief shaped divinity and divinity shaped belief.

This is how new gods became possible. Vapaz and Zopha were not just the children of Haxenylian and Lady Gaialana. They were new gods, a concept that did not exist until their birth, because mortal belief made room for them. They were born of hybrid forces: divine parentage, shifting mortal belief, and Haxenylian's love for a human woman.

The Threat the New Gods Posed

From Mikani's perspective, Vapaz and Zopha were noise-disruptions to the original harmony. The Old Gods had emerged from Noirta's first song. They were primordial. Foundational. The New Gods emerged from something different: mortal belief, changing needs. They were born of hybrid forces the original cosmos had not called for.

Mikani felt fear. He had fought to establish order in a chaotic universe, and these new beings threatened to undo everything. Renedin saw Mikani's fear and fed it, whispering that war was coming regardless, that the children would eventually

challenge their uncles for dominance. Poaranji believed what his brothers told him. Only Haxenylian stood apart. Only he saw his children as family rather than threat. And so the brothers who had once been a single chord turned against each other.

Renedin's Goals

Renedin now waits in the Garden of Unspoken Names, partially awake, planning. His goal is not destruction for its own sake. He wants to unmake the additions-strip away the barrier, the New Gods, the whole messy overlay that came after the original harmony. Return reality to the state where the Song played uninterrupted, where he and his brothers were the only voices that mattered.

In his mind, he is not the villain. He is the restoration. He wants to go home. Breaking the barrier would reset the cosmos to primordial chaos, where Renedin's domain of dreams and the mental realm would have equal footing with physical reality. In dreams, he is god. In the pure Song, before mortals complicated everything with their belief and their stories and their capacity to change things, he was part of something whole. That is what he wants back.

In truth, Renedin is a manipulator who plays victim. He destroyed his own family and blames everyone else. He is incapable of genuine accountability. He has been waiting thousands of years in the Garden with nothing to do but think and plan and whisper to anyone who will listen. The Brotherhood of Westwinds believes he was wrongfully imprisoned for trying to "preserve the old ways." Their sacred text, the Tome of Renedin, is likely influenced by dreams he has sent from the Garden-he has been recruiting from his prison.

A Note on the Saints

The twelve primeval Saints are described in religious texts as having "come before the world was the world, long before the sea was the sea." This is religious poetry, not literal chronology. The Saints were created after the War of Gods I, as part of Iswan's proposal to Vapaz. They are a post-war institution, not a primordial one.

Over millennia, believers embellished the origin stories, using creation-myth language to make their Saints sound foundational and ancient. This is consistent with how religion works in this world. The Brotherhood of Westwinds has disputed origin stories about Oleahak's prophecy. The Circle of Eternal Light merged old

and new worship in ways that smooth over historical tensions. Religious texts get revised, reframed, exaggerated. The Saints being described in primordial terms despite their relatively recent invention is exactly the kind of pious embellishment that accumulates over thousands of years.

The Circle of Eternal Light's Teaching on the Pertari Stairs

The Circle teaches that corruption is a wound a soul inflicts upon itself. Their founding texts, drawn from Vekta's speeches and Aryanara's writings, describe the Pertari Stairs not as punishment but as consequence. Noirta does not cast souls out in anger. The Song cannot hold what has made itself unholdable.

This distinction matters deeply to Circle theology—the gods do not damn anyone. Souls damn themselves. Their priests do not threaten sinners with the Stairs the way a parent might threaten a child with a switch. Instead, they teach harmony. They teach that every choice either draws a soul closer to its true note or pulls it further away. Small dissonances can be corrected across lifetimes. A cruel man in one life might be born with a gentle heart in the next, the Song naturally rebalancing what was off-key. But sustained, deliberate, total dissonance—the kind that comes from surrendering entirely to wrath, or bargaining away the core of oneself—creates damage the Song cannot repair.

The Circle also teaches compassion for the corrupted. Those on the Stairs were once part of the same Song as everyone else. They were someone's mother, someone's child. Priests lead prayers for the lost souls not because prayer can save them—nothing can—but because remembering them keeps the living connected to the weight of their own choices.

The Brotherhood of Westwinds' Interpretation of the Stairs

The Brotherhood sees it differently. Their theology centers the Old Gods as the true divine order, with the New Gods as usurpers who disrupted the original harmony. To them, the Pertari Stairs are not a natural consequence but a creation—a prison built by Vapaz and his followers to punish those who would not submit to the new regime. They point to Renedin's imprisonment in the Garden of Unspoken

Names as proof. If the New Gods would cage one of the primordial brothers, why would they not cage mortal souls who defied them?

The Brotherhood teaches that souls sent to the Stairs are not corrupted at all. They are resistant. Warriors who refused to kneel. Sorcerers who sought power outside the temples' control. Followers of the Old Gods who would not abandon their faith. The Stairs, in this telling, are where the New Gods discard anyone who threatens their authority.

This interpretation serves the Brotherhood's recruitment well. They whisper to the angry, the ambitious, the dispossessed: the Circle tells you to stay small, to stay harmonious, to accept your place in their Song. But whose Song is it really? The gods who stole heaven from its rightful rulers want you docile. They want you afraid of corruption so you never reach for real power. It is a seductive lie wrapped around a kernel of theological dispute. And because the Brotherhood's sacred text-the Tome of Renedin-is influenced by dreams sent from the Garden itself, their teachings carry the weight of something that feels like revelation.

What the Gods Actually Know

The truth is more complicated than either faith admits. The Pertari Stairs predate the gods. They existed before Mikani crystallized from Noirta, before Haxenylian emerged to protect what had been created. The Stairs are not divine architecture. They are simply what happens when a soul falls out of harmony with existence itself. The gods did not build them any more than they built gravity.

But the gods do not correct the Brotherhood's lies, and the Circle's priests do not fully understand what they teach. Vapaz has never explained the Stairs to his followers. Nimlye, who guards Renedin's prison and understands liminal spaces better than any other god, keeps her knowledge close. Even the Old Gods, in their time, did not speak of the Stairs openly.

Some scholars in Vikistv's Magic Tower suspect this silence is intentional-that the gods fear what mortals might do if they fully understood the mechanics of corruption. Others believe the gods themselves do not entirely understand it. The Stairs emerged from Noirta before consciousness existed to study them. What the gods do know is this: the Stairs are permanent. No divine power has ever retrieved a soul from them. No prayer, no bargain, no intervention can undo corruption once it has taken hold.

Aryanara and Vekta: The Twin Prophets of the Circle

The twin sisters lived sometime around 14,300 – 14,200BR, during an era when the saints still walked among mortals and the world was younger. They were not saints themselves—they carried no fraction of a god's power—but they lived close enough to that age to witness its miracles firsthand. Perhaps they studied under one of the earlier saints, or perhaps they simply observed with clearer eyes than most.

What made them remarkable was not divine power but divine understanding. While the saints reshaped mountains and built cities, Aryanara and Vekta turned their attention to something subtler: the nature of the soul itself. They studied Noirta—the myth of the first song, the endless cycle of souls—and translated its cosmic poetry into something mortals could comprehend and follow. They were the first to articulate that death was merely a pause in a longer song, that souls carried traces of their past lives into new bodies, that corruption was the only true ending.

The sisters traveled and taught together, but eventually each established her own center of learning. These became the first temples of what would become the Circle of Eternal Light—not grand structures like the Peknas of later centuries, but modest gathering places where seekers came to learn.

Aryanara might have been the more contemplative twin, drawn to the philosophical and metaphysical aspects of the soul's journey. Her territory in what became the eastern heartland of Gherci, with its fertile river valleys, attracted scholars and thinkers. She emphasized memory, the way souls carry echoes of past lives, the eternal nature of the spirit. She recorded Vekta's speeches, and these writings became the foundational texts of the Circle.

Vekta might have been the more practical sister, focused on the rituals and daily practices that kept a soul pure. Her territory in what became the northern highlands, near the mist-shrouded mountains forming the border with Equateiy, drew pilgrims seeking purification and protection. She emphasized action—how to live in harmony with the Song, how to recognize the signs of corruption, how to protect oneself and others from spiritual decay. Her famous quote: "They hear the Song and call it a cage. They do not understand that the cage is the only thing keeping them whole."

The formal founding of the Circle of Eternal Light in 14,271 BR was the culmination of their life's work. After the sisters died, the sites where they taught became places of pilgrimage. The lands briefly bore their names before being incorporated into Gherci by Saint Duri in 8,763 BR.

House Catern's Sacred Role

House Catern's motto, "For the age of origin and for the strength of Aryanara and Vekta," claims three things: guardianship of the primordial era's truths, protection of the physical lands where the twins taught, and spiritual allegiance to the Circle's founding principles. Their Archduke rank reflects the sacred importance of the territories they protect. Against competing beliefs like the Brotherhood of Westwinds, which venerates only the gods of old, House Catern stands as a bulwark for the Circle's teachings: that old and new are part of the same eternal song, and that humanity's souls have been singing since the very beginning.

MATSIALI

Type: Cultural-Religious Ideology

Era: Pre-0 AR (dominant culture of the Solisian Empire before the Dark Ages)

Status: Abolished by imperial decree in 36 AR; effectively destroyed

Core Beliefs: Matsiali was the dominant cultural framework of the Solisian Empire throughout its golden millennia. It valued female leadership, sexual freedom, and a balance of power between genders. Under Matsiali, women held positions of authority, matriarchal inheritance was common, and female education was widespread. Saints like Duri and Siriande were honored as paragons, and female rulers and warriors were celebrated in art, literature, and religious practice.

Relationship to Religion: Though not a religion in itself, Matsiali shaped how the Circle of Eternal Light was practiced. The pantheon was worshipped in balance - goddesses received equal reverence to gods, and female clergy held significant power within temple hierarchies. The Matsiali worldview reinforced the Circle's core belief in equality and unity.

Abolition: In 36 AR, Emperor Goteivati Zivc Patton III - "Goteivati the Damned" - issued an imperial decree condemning Matsiali as weak and corrupt. He declared "men are superior, by divine design" and systematically dismantled Matsiali

traditions. Women were stripped of positions of authority, matriarchal inheritance rights were revoked, and female education was outlawed. Texts praising past empresses and female heroes were destroyed. Matsiali was replaced by Pataoiut.

Legacy: Though officially eradicated, Matsiali's influence survived in fragments - in the stories of the saints, in the legal codes (like the Yerian Laws and Code of Esa) that predated Goteivati's reign, and in the private practices of families who quietly preserved old traditions. By Minara's era (~ 2, 632AR), Matsiali exists only as a historical memory of what the empire once was.

See Also: PATAOIUT, LENEYEZ, GOTEIVATI III (Historical Figures)

PATAOIUT

1Created By: Emperor Goteivati Zivc Patton III ("Goteivati the Damned")

Status: Dominant imperial culture from 36 AR through the Dark Ages and beyond; partially reformed by Emperor Astyan II (~ 1, 852 AR) but culturally persistent into Minara's era (~ 2, 632 AR)

Core Beliefs: Pataoiut is an aggressively conservative, male-dominated ideology that demands the worship of men as earthly representatives of divine will. Under Pataoiut, women are forced into subservience and men are exalted in all things. The Emperor is positioned as the nearly divine apex of this hierarchy. Male superiority is framed as divinely ordained - "men are to be worshipped as gods on earth."

Religious Transformation: Goteivati III did not create a new religion but fundamentally corrupted existing religious practice. Temples were rededicated to male saints and gods. Texts praising past empresses or female heroes were destroyed. Female participation in clergy was banned. Statues of reigning men replaced icons of goddesses in shrines. The Emperor's own name was incorporated into daily prayers. The sub-religion of Leneyez - which had involved sacrificial offerings to please the gods - was twisted to focus on sacrifices honoring the Emperor and male ancestors. Priests were compelled to proclaim the male form as sacred by design.

Enforcement: Dissent was ruthlessly crushed by imperial agents, including remnants of the Council of the Forsaken, which was repurposed to enforce Pataoiut orthodoxy. Many commoners secretly viewed the changes as heresy but could not openly resist.

Reforms and Persistence: Approximately 780 years before Minara's era, Emperor Astyan II implemented reforms that reversed the worst cruelties of Pataoiut - but his reforms addressed governance and immediate excesses rather than fundamental cultural assumptions. Pataoiut's emphasis on male dominance, conservative values, and hierarchical social structures remained embedded in society. The empire Minara inhabits (~ 2,632AR) is technically post-reform, but the cultural damage persists. The apparent stability masks a rotting core.

See Also: MATSIALI, LENEYEZ, GOTEIVATI III (Historical Figures)

DIVINE INTERVENTIONS DURING THE AICRUAN CIVIL WAR

RAZAR, GOD OF THE SUN - SOLIS ERA ACTIONS

Role: Solis's divine protector and patron

Divine Contract with Solis (~ 7,234BR):

During Solis's exile on the Mystic Isles, Razar accepted a pledge from the young prince. Solis exchanged a strand of his hair in return for the ability to devise war tactics.

Razar accepted and granted the skill. This pledge is the foundation of Solis's military genius throughout the civil war and his subsequent conquest.

Location of Pledge: The Mystic Isles (Chapter 5)

Intervention at the Fight of Titian (7,217 BR): During Civil War Year Five, Razar directly intervened on Solis's behalf by blinding Dame Kisaleli — one of Orcus's most feared warriors - during combat. This is one of the few confirmed instances of direct divine intervention in the civil war, and it tips the battle decisively in Solis's favor.

Significance: Razar's patronage of Solis reinforces the theme that divine favor does not equal moral righteousness. The god of the sun backs a man who will become a tyrant, which complicates the Circle of Eternal Light's theology in the imperial era that follows.

Cross-references:

- SOLIS ELIAS PATTON (In Story Characters)

- THE FIGHT OF TITIAN (Key Words and Terms)
- DAME KISALELI (In Story Characters / Historical Figures)

NELLEBRIE, GODDESS OF DISASTERS - SOLIS ERA ACTIONS

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Role: Harnua's patron goddess; "unwitting" architect of Esterica's death

The Ilkai Deal (7,214 BR):

After Orcus's death, Harnua approached Nellebrie and made a deal. Nellebrie lent Harnua the divine power necessary to bypass Razar's protection of Solis and provided access to Ilkai - a god-killing herb. The intended target was Solis, but Empress Esterica accidentally drank the poisoned cup instead.

Cross-references:

- HARNUA KULIO (In Story Characters)
- ILKAI (Key Words and Terms)
- NELLEBRIE personality profile (Religion - God Personalities)
- DORTHARGEL, Saint 4 (Religion - Saints) - previous

Nellebrie saint; parallel grief response

SOLIS'S RELIGIOUS LEGACY

THE CIRCLE OF ETERNAL LIGHT UNDER SOLIS

The official faith of Aicruae - the Circle of Eternal Light, a pantheistic religion venerating twelve deities equally remained the state religion under Solis's rule. The state canon (Zyrathia) and its triangular temples (Peknas) ensured that worship was uniform across the realm. However, Solis's relationship with religion was complicated:

- He was personally pledged to Razar above all other gods

- He attacked the Cidet (the great temple) during Year Three of the war, turning the church against him
- After Harnua's execution, he launched a persecution of magic users - conflating magical ability with religious threat
- The church eventually realigned with Solis after his victory, as the Circle of Eternal Light became the imperial default that legitimized the new order

The Persecution of Magic Users (post-7,214 BR):

After Esterica's death by Harnua's poison, grief-maddened Solis launched a campaign to wipe out all magic users who practiced magic in the kingdoms, fearing they could become threats like Harnua. This persecution drove magic users into flight, creating a diaspora that would not be resolved until well into the Reconstruction period under Emperor Goteivati Zivc III, when magic users began to marry and fully integrate into society.

Cross-references:

- CIRCLE OF ETERNAL LIGHT (Religion - existing section)
- THE CIDET (Locations)
- MAGIC SYSTEM (Magic System hub doc)
- SOLIS ELIAS PATTON (In Story Characters)

Reincarnation Manifestations in Crown of Glory

The Circle of Eternal Light's doctrine of reincarnation - that souls never truly die but are reborn in new lives unless they become irredeemably corrupted - is central to Crown of Glory's plot and its resolution of the full series.

Three key reincarnation connections drive the final book:

Minara Gonia is the reincarnation of Soli and Apharia's daughter - the child Vapaz killed during the War of Gods II as punishment for the forbidden union between a god and a mortal. This is not

revealed to the reader until the very end: in the great emptiness, Apharia tells Soli that their daughter "went to meet him a while ago," confirming Minara's identity.

Minara was also raised by Siadou Gonia, who is the reincarnation of Enyokia (Vandrea's older sister, sold into slavery during Solis's conquest). Neither Minara

nor Siadou knew their cosmic connection - the niece raised by her aunt's soul across lifetimes.

Empress Macenja Lorafoamenti Patton is the vessel of Vandrea - not a traditional reincarnation but an identity theft. Vandrea killed the real Macenja before the imperial marriage and assumed her identity using shapeshifting granted by Renedin. Unlike a true reincarnation, Vandrea has lived continuously for over 10,000 years, her soul corrupted by Renedin's influence and her own grief.

Professor Leranoan Gevhilem is Soli - the twin gods Paxtino (God of Rebirth, Peace, and Redemption) and Ekhasostio (God of Vengeance, Desire, Greed, and Chaos) walking in mortal form. After Apharia's death, Soli denied his right to godhood and chose to live secretly among mortals. His mortal guise as a professor at the Solisian Academy places him near Minara - his daughter's reincarnation - though whether he knows this from the start or discovers it during the story remains unresolved.

The culmination of these reincarnation threads occurs in the final battle: Minara uses her magic with Soli's help to ensure that Vandrea's corrupted soul enters the great emptiness rather than facing eternal despair. In the great emptiness, Vandrea finally reunites with Enyokia and Apharia - the three sisters together again after 10,000 years of separation. They can now reincarnate together. The cycle is closed.

WHY SAINTS STOPPED AFTER HARNUA

The gods stopped creating saints after Harnua because they feared her god-like power. With her dying breath, Harnua raised a second moon — an act of power that terrified the divine pantheon. The decision was not a formal decree but a silent agreement among the gods born of pure self-preservation. No god wanted to risk creating another mortal who could wield that kind of force.

The official explanations given to mortals - that humanity became unworthy, that the gods grew distant - are false. The gods simply got scared. Upon Harnua's execution she is the last saint ever created.

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Type: Cultural-Religious Ideology

Era: 36 AR onward 